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Introducing AI in Schools

Beyond budgetary allocation, the AI curriculum needs real world intersections

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CAN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI)

“think” like humans? Can AI predictions be trusted completely—Why or why not? What happens if Machine Learning models are trained with wrong data? Why should we not copy from AI? What should we do if AI gives the wrong answer? Can AI be fair and kind?

These are not just musings but critical paths of inquiry reinforcing the need for AI education in schools. By introducing AI, data science, and ethical digital practices early in schools we prepare our future workforce to be curious thinkers, problem solvers, innovators, informed digital citizens, and ethical AI practitioners.

This begs the question how are we navigating the pathway to introducing AI education in schools? The Ministry of Education, Government of India, has constituted a committee to draft a curriculum to introduce AI and computational thinking in schools from Class III. While this is welcome, introducing AI incrementally may deprive a whole generation of critical employ-

able skills. We hope that the next Union Budget will include a provision for AI education in schools on a mission mode for AI education right up to Class XII—with speed and scale—to enable schools to match strides with industry expectations.

Building a digitally empowered India starts with empowering every child with future skills today. AI and disruptive technologies signal a 51% skill gap in India. The country needs more than one million AI-

portant channel for educating our youth in real world scenarios—where students can learn that AI models learn from data and feedback to make predictions. **But true intelligence comes from understanding its decisions** and using them responsibly and fairly or from knowing that AI is not just about technology—it is about solving real problems responsibly, exploring new careers, and making a positive impact on society. It is understand-

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skilled engineers in two to three years, according to NASSCOM. The demand-supply mismatch will widen to 30% by 2028. Further, with the need for ‘Talent Acceleration’ in line with national priorities around IndiaAI Mission, India Semiconductor Mission, automation and precision technologies, the lack of a digitally-skilled workforce can become a bottleneck leading to significant opportunity cost. We are not discussing a subject. This is national strategy.

AI Education can be an im-

ing that ML is computers learning from data to help us solve problems. **The real intelligence comes from how we use it responsibly** or understanding that personalisation by generative AI can create “filter bubbles,” along one’s existing understanding or preferences—but collaborating with humans in a diverse dialogue will expand the boundaries of one’s knowledge.

In most learning situations, logic is not an active consideration during curriculum transaction—and yet an important curtain raiser on